PHP string is a sequence of characters i.e., used to store and manipulate text. PHP supports only 256-character set and so that it does not offer native Unicode support. There are 4 ways to specify a string literal in PHP.

We can create a string in PHP by enclosing the text in a single-quote. It is the easiest way to specify string in PHP. For specifying a literal single quote, escape it with a backslash (\) and to specify a literal backslash (\) use double backslash (\\). All the other instances with backslash such as \r or \n, will be output same as they specified instead of having any special meaning.

4.1 BASIC PHP STRING FUNCTIONS

A PHP string is a sequence of characters i.e. used to store and manipulate text. A string is a collection of characters. String is one of the data types supported by PHP. The string variables can contain alphanumeric characters. Strings are created when;

- You declare variable and assign string characters to it
- You can directly use them with echo statement.
- String are language construct, it helps capture words.
- Learning how strings work in PHP and how to manipulate them will make you a very effective and productive developer.

They are sequences of characters, like “PHP supports string operations”.

Built-in string functions is given in function reference PHP String Functions

Following are valid examples of string

$string_1 = “This is a string in double quotes”;

$string_2 = “This is a somewhat longer, singly quoted string”;

$string_39 = “This string has thirty-nine characters”;

$string_0 = “”; // a string with zero characters

Singly quoted strings are treated almost literally, whereas doubly quoted strings replace variables with their values as well as specially interpreting certain character sequences.

```
<?php
   $variable = “name”;
   $literally = ‘My $variable will not print!\\n’;

   print($literally);
   print “<br />”;
```